

EQ Credit: Quality Views

This credit applies to

- ▶ BD+C: New Construction (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Core & Shell (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Schools (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Retail (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Data Centers (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Warehouses & Distribution Centers (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Hospitality (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Healthcare (1 point)

INTENT

To give building occupants a connection to the natural outdoor environment by providing quality views.

REQUIREMENTS

NC, CS, SCHOOLS, RETAIL, DATA CENTERS, HOSPITALITY

Provide occupants in the building with a view to the outdoor natural or urban environment for 75% of all regularly occupied floor area. Auditoriums, conference rooms dedicated to video conferencing, and gymnasiums may be excluded. Views into interior atria may be used to meet up to 30% of the required area.

Views must be through glass with a visible light transmittance (VLT) above 40%. If the glazing has frits, patterns, or tints the view must be preserved. Neutral gray, bronze, and blue-green tints are acceptable.

Views must include at least one of the following:

- ▶ nature, urban landmarks, or art; or
- ▶ objects at least 25 feet (7.5 meters) from the exterior of the glazing.

Occupants must have direct access to the view and be within three times the head height of the glazing.

WAREHOUSES & DISTRIBUTION CENTERS

For the office portion of the building, meet the requirements above.

For the bulk storage, sorting, and distribution portions of the building, ^{meet} the requirements above for 25% of the regularly occupied floor area.

HEALTHCARE

For inpatient units (IPUs), meet the requirements above (1 point).

For other areas, configure the building floor plates such that the floor area within 15 feet (4.5 meters) of the perimeter exceeds the perimeter area requirement (Table 1), and meet the requirements above for the perimeter area (1 point).

Table 1. Minimum compliant perimeter area, by floor plate area

Floor plate area		Perimeter area	
(square feet)	(square meters)	(square feet)	(square meters)
Up to 15,000	Up to 1 400	7,348	682
20,000	1 800	8,785	816

25,000	2 300	10,087	937
30,000	2 800	11,292	1 049
35,000	3 300	12,425	1 154
40,000	3 700	13,500	1 254
45,000	4 200	14,528	1 349
50,000 and larger	4 600 and larger	15,516	1 441

GUIDANCE

Refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following additions and modifications:

Behind the Intent

Beta Update

Specific criteria for the glazing characteristics have been added to address challenges with determining acceptable levels of clarity, frits, fibers, patterns, tints and to minimize conflicts with the Pilot Credit for Bird Collision Deterrence.

The view requirements were also revised to better differentiate criteria for view content from criteria for view access and to eliminate potentially redundant requirements.

The requirements for healthcare have been revised for clarity.

Step-by-Step Guidance

Step 1-3. Refer to these steps in the LEED v4 reference guide

Step 4. Identify Site Lines to the Exterior

On floor plans or furniture plans, identify the locations of perimeter and interior glazing and all permanent interior obstructions.

- ▶ Determine whether the perimeter and interior glazing meets the credit requirements for VLT, frits/patterns, and tints.
 - Recommended frit patterns to reduce bird collisions and preserve quality views are no thicker than 1/8 inch (3.175 millimeters) and spaced every 2 inches (5.08 centimeters) vertically and 4 inches (10.16 centimeters) horizontally.
- ▶ Identify interior features that may block the view to the window, such as structural columns. Vertical columns smaller than 1-foot (0.3 meters) wide and horizontal features smaller than 1-foot (0.3 meters) high typically do not block views. Movable furniture and partitions as well as movable glare control devices may be included, but this is not required.
- ▶ Consider performing an initial rough assessment before performing detailed assessment of view quality. Determine whether the regularly occupied floor area with proximity to vision glazing is at least 75% of the total regularly occupied floor area.

Step 5. Assess View Quality

Identify whether the view includes nature, urban landmarks or art, or objects at least 25 feet (7.5 meters) from the exterior of the glazing.

Step 6. Confirm Compliance

Complete the tracking table to confirm that at least 75% of the regularly occupied floor area has access to a quality view. For warehouses and distribution centers and Healthcare projects, See Further Explanation, Rating System Variations section in the LEED v4 Reference Guide.

Further Explanation

Healthcare projects refer to the following sections in the LEED v4 Reference guide: Calculations perimeter area, special considerations for healthcare projects,

Required Documentation

- ▶ List of regularly occupied spaces, qualifying floor area in each space, and view features
- ▶ Sections, elevations, diagrams, renderings, or photos indicating sight lines to glazing do not encounter permanent interior obstructions.
- ▶ Floor plans or diagrams identifying the views to nature, urban landmarks, or objects at least 25 feet (7.5 meters) accessible to the occupants.
- ▶ Glazing specifications confirming compliance with VLT, frit/pattern, and tint requirements.

Connection to Ongoing Performance

- ▶ LEED O+M EQ prerequisite Indoor Environmental Quality Performance: Strategies to promote connection of building occupants to natural outdoor environment by providing quality views in newly constructed buildings can contribute to better indoor environmental quality and overall occupant satisfaction during operations phase.